

Part 1

Read Passage One and answer questions 1-5 on the Question-Answer Book.

Passage One:

'Zero to Hero' movie review: the moving story behind Hong Kong's 12-time Paralympic medallist So Wa-wai

- 1 [1] "Don't let your child lose at the starting line" is a common saying among modern Hong Kong parents. Based on the true story of Hong Kong's twelve-time Paralympic medallist So Wa-wai, the movie Zero to Hero tells the touching tale of how people who seemed to "lose" on the starting line can still achieve victory as long as they persist.
- 5 [2] A baby crying on a dark night sets up the first scene of the film. So's mother, played by seasoned actress Sandra Ng Kwan-yue, receives grim news about her son being diagnosed with jaundice. This disease results in cerebral palsy – meaning So would struggle to walk and feed himself for the rest of his life. Yet, his mother is determined that her son will never be ordinary, and begins her journey raising a future sporting star.
- 10 [3] The film chronicles So's life from birth until the 2008 Beijing Games, where he raced for his last gold medal on the Paralympic tracks. In his solo feature directing debut, director Jimmy Wan Chi-man illustrates the personal and physical challenges behind the success of the legendary sprinter. Wan ties the story of So's glory to that of his mother.
- 15 [4] When young So is unable to walk at the age of four, his frustrated mother feels hopeless. Feeling defeated, she puts her child on a factory conveyor belt which usually drops clothes for disposal, and plans to end both their lives as she feels bleak about their future. Despite his mother's abusive behaviour, young So (Choi Tin-nok) miraculously stands up on his feeble legs for the first time. The overjoyed mother regains her will to live in hopes that her son will accomplish great things one day. And her son does not fail her.
- 20 [5] After being recruited to the city's para-athletics team, the 15-year-old So (Fung Ho-yeung) wins his first gold medal at the 1996 Atlanta Paralympics. Not only is this a major personal achievement for him, but it is Hong Kong's first ever Paralympic gold. A particularly moving scene is when the humble So brings the medal home, puts the heavy gold around his mother's neck, and thanks her for believing in him and using every penny she had to support his dreams, even when the family was struggling financially. He promises his mother that he will win many more gold medals to compensate for how she did not have any gold as dowry at her wedding. The tight bond between the mother and the son is especially touching because of all the difficulties they have faced together. As he continues training, So rises as a superstar in international races, scooping up medals and breaking world records.
- 30 [6] However, the sprinter soon faces a dilemma that has been lurking in the background of the film's story – his family is poor, and when his father gets injured and is unable to work, the runner is stuck between putting bread on the table and following his dreams. During this time, the adult So (Leung Chung-hang) puts on a uniform to make deliveries in the day, while he trains at night. In one touching scene, So tells his mother he wants to give up running because he cannot bear to watch his family living on scraps while he pursues his passion. Although So eventually receives support from Hong Kong celebrity Andy Lau Tak-wah to continue his athletic dreams, this moment in the film reflects the reality that many of the city's disabled athletes are deterred from their sports because they do not receive enough subsidies from the government.
- 35 [7] Overall, the movie is inspirational and moving. The theme song, "Road to Miracles", is sung by up-and-coming Canto-pop star Jer Lau, accompanied by the angelic voices of the Hong Kong Children's Choir. It wraps up the film perfectly pulling at the audience's heartstrings. The most striking lines from the song, "falling behind doesn't mean losing, it just means you have to run faster and catch up", echo So's life perfectly.
- 40 [8] Zero to Hero is a typical sports inspirational movie with a focus on family and the critical situation of Hong Kong's community of disabled athletes. It is an entertaining watch, and it ends swiftly without prolonging the melodrama that would have made it borderline cliché. Hopefully, it can inspire Hongkongers to think about how we can better support our city's disabled people.
- 45 [9] Over the span of his inspirational athletic journey, the real-life So Wa-wai raced for Hong Kong in five Paralympic Games from 1996 to 2012, winning 12 medals in total. Dubbed the "magic kid", the 39-year-old is still the current world record holder in the men's T36 in 100m and 200m. So may have begun slowly at the starting line, but he eventually sprinted faster than anyone on the track – and in life. He has never been treated as an ordinary person, and that is what makes him extraordinary.

Read Passage Two and answer questions 6-12 on the Question-Answer Book.

Passage Two:

The Never-ending Land Use Conflicts

- 1 [1] Land is scarce in Hong Kong and people do not always agree on how it should be used, or whose rights should take precedence. These issues have often led to disputes. Competing interests have to be balanced, but the exercise has never been easy – especially for the government.
- 5 [2] There are many land use issues in Hong Kong that have created controversies. Two major areas of dispute are where the need for development clashes with that of conservation, and when private rights run into public interest.
- 10 [3] When bulldozers uproot trees, some people see progress and wait with anticipation for new facilities; others lament the loss of more natural countryside. Yet, as the population continues to grow, land development must go on, and destruction of the natural environment is the inevitable price we pay. For development to be sustainable, we need to balance the needs of environmental protection, society and the economy. Much of the focus of conservation in Hong Kong is on country parks, which are protected by law. Most land of high ecological value, meanwhile, is located on flat land in the parks.
- 15 [4] In the past, country park land had to be released for building houses or facilities from time to time. For example, the Ngong Ping 360 cable car runs on country park land. But not all proposed use of country park land was permitted. Protests from conservationists prompted lawmakers to reject a proposal to open new landfills in Tseung Kwan O. We must remember that country parks help maintain a pleasant overall living environment and using them for development will not only diminish quality of life for people, but also upset natural ecology and threaten biodiversity.
- 20 [5] When the government proposed to designate Tai Long Sai Wan in Sai Kung as a country park and restrict private land there to agricultural use, landowners were up in arms. That was a typical example of how disputes arise when private and public interests clash over land use. In zoning the area as a country park, the government's purpose was conservation. But this would diminish the value of private land there, and quash villagers' economic aspirations. In fact, similar situations have been occurring over the years as private plots were resumed for various public purposes, including building railway lines, highways or housing estates.
- 25 [6] There are legal procedures for public land resumption for public purposes. In doing so, the government is representing the community as a whole, and must limit the amount of compensation as it involves public money. But what the government considers "fair compensation" may not satisfy landowners. In some cases, people affected may not want monetary compensation at all. People who have lived in villages for generations may not want to leave. But minority interests do sometimes have to be sacrificed for the interest of the majority. Whether it is 'fair' to do so is a hard question to answer.
- 30 [7] When the population grows and new families are formed, demand for housing increases. In fact, demand for housing in Hong Kong has always been acute, and the shortage of building land has been a chronic problem. To increase supply of residential land, the government intends to release 152 plots in various districts, originally zoned for green belt or institutional use, to build homes. This decision was immediately criticised by local residents and green groups. The dilemma is apparent. On the one hand, there is pressure for the supply of new homes; on the other hand, there is a demand for conservation. There is also tension in apportioning land between public and private housing, a tricky balance as there are severe shortages in both types of housing.
- 35 [8] It is inconceivable that modern people go back to living in jungles, so more of the natural countryside will have to give way to urbanisation eventually. But if in the process we kill all forests and vegetation, we will destroy natural ecology and biodiversity, and bring unthinkable consequences upon mankind. Development is inevitable, so we must make sure that it is sustainable. Exercising restraint and good planning, and taking into account the environment, are the key factors. There is no easy solution, but ensuring development is led by need instead of greed is, perhaps, the closest we can get to a usable guideline!
- 40

END OF READING PASSAGES

**FORM 2****GENERAL ENGLISH****QUESTION-ANSWER BOOK**

Name: _____

Class: _____

Class Number: _____

Set 6**Part 1 – Reading Comprehension (30 marks)****For each multiple-choice question, darken the appropriate circle. Otherwise, no mark will be awarded.****Passage One (14 marks)**

1. Find a word in Paragraphs 2 to 4 which has the meaning as each of the phrases below. (4 marks)

- (i) having a lot of experience of doing something and therefore knowing how to do it well _____
- (ii) makes a record or give details of something _____
- (iii) the first performance or presentation of something to the public _____
- (iv) very weak, particularly as a result of age or illness _____

2. According to Paragraph 6, what is the dilemma that So faced? (2 marks)

3. Who sang the theme song “Road to Miracles”?

4. Scarlet is writing a biography of So Wa Wai. Please help her complete the following table. Use only ONE word in each blank. Make sure your answers are grammatically correct. (4 marks)

Nickname	The (i) _____ kid
Impairment	He was born with (ii) _____, which affected his development and balance.
Sport	Men’s 100m, Men’s 200m Classification: (iii) _____
Achievements	The (iv) _____ medals he won at the Paralympic Games between 1996 and 2012.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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5. Below is a summary of the movie. In two of the lines, there is ONE mistake. If you find a mistake, underline the mistake and replace the word with one that expresses the correct idea. Write the word in the space on the right. If there is no mistake, put a tick (✓) in the space. One line has been done for you as an example. (3 marks)

	Summary	Correction
(i)	Actor Jimmy Wan depicts the disabled sprinter, who was born with cerebral palsy,	
(ii)	as he breaks local records while struggling to support his impoverished family.	
e.g.	This movie reflects the struggles that many of Hong Kong's <u>children</u> face, and highlights	para-athletes
(iii)	the stigma that disabled children face in society and even from their own parents.	

Passage Two (16 marks)

6. Use the information in the article to decide whether the following statements are True, False or Not Given. (3 marks)

	T	F	NG
(i) Nearly all land of high ecological value is found on the edge of country parks.	☐	☐	☐
(ii) Lawmakers consider the opinions of conservationists to be more important than the government's.	☐	☐	☐
(iii) The value of private land depreciates if the land is resumed for public purposes.	☐	☐	☐

7. What does 'That' (line 20) refer to?

8. Why might the government not offer more generous compensation to landowners when resuming their land?

9. Which word in Paragraph 7 suggests that the housing problem has persisted for a long time?

10. Which of the following words can best replace 'inconceivable' in line 38?

A. likely	A
B. incredible	B
C. unimaginable	C
D. probable	D

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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11. Match the headings to the corresponding paragraphs. Write the letters (A-E) next to each paragraph. One heading is not used. (4 marks)

Heading
A. Personal interest vs public interest
B. Quality of life
C. No easy solution
D. Development vs conservation
E. Shortage of housing land

Paragraph
3-4
5-6
7
8

12. Lilian is writing a summary of the article. Please help her complete the following paragraph. Use only ONE word in each blank. Make sure your answers are grammatically correct. (5 marks)

Hong Kong has a very small land area compared to its huge (i) _____, and there is always a (ii) _____ of land for development. Hong Kong's government and community are conscious of the need for development to be (iii) _____, as building must be viable and have positive impacts in the long term and not just provide a short-term fix. Various laws are in place to ensure this. But striking a (iv) _____ between different land use needs is not easy and has often created (v) _____.

END OF PART 1

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Part 2 – English Usage (70 marks)

A. Verb Forms (10 marks)

Fill in the blanks with the words provided in brackets in their correct forms.

Easing Traffic Congestion

Hong Kong has a very large population in relation to its size, and it has long been plagued by congested traffic. During peak hours, passengers (1) (pack) like sardines on MTR trains. The stress of riding overcrowded public transport and air pollution caused by vehicle exhaust fumes are taking a continuous toll on people's health.

The traffic problems are worse in commercial districts, most of which (2) (develop) early in Hong Kong's history when town planning was inadequate. Their narrow streets are choked by heavy traffic as the number of residents and businesses (3) (grow) over the years. In fact, most metropolitan areas in the world (4) (face) similar headaches.

The most common strategy is (5) (develop) a mass transit system and take measures to reduce the number of vehicles on the roads.

Sweden: congestion tax

The country's capital, Stockholm, levies a congestion tax on vehicles (6) (enter) the city centre between 6am and 6pm.

Singapore: ownership tax + ERP

Singapore has an Electronic Road Pricing scheme – the first in the world – under which motorists (7) (charge) for using priced roads during peak hours. There is also a very stiff tax on importing cars to deter ownership.

Beijing: odd-even policy

To clear the air over the city in preparation for the 2008 Summer Olympics, Beijing (8) (introduce) a temporary 'odd-even road use rationing policy' in July that year. Under the policy, cars were allowed (9) (use) the road only on alternate days according to the last number on their licence plates. Odd numbers go on day one, even numbers on day two, and so on. The policy proved so successful that the Beijing government (10) (decide) to keep it after the Olympics, to be invoked on days of high air pollution levels.

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.	6.	7.	8.
9.	10.		

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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B. Vocabulary (5 marks)

Choose the most suitable words from the table below to complete the passage. You may need to change the form of some words. Each word should only be used **once**.

in my eyes	appoint	take a back seat
superior	take a hard line on	grateful
conditional	company	in my corner

Dear Mum,

I am forever grateful for having a dear mother like you. Throughout the joys and sorrows, triumphs and struggles, you have been (1) as a friend, (2) and guide. You have taught me to be caring and compassionate and to love (3).

I had the best childhood anyone could have wished for. As a kid I remember the fun and games, the nutritious meals, the laughter. You accompanied me to most extracurricular activities, Parents' Days and medical (4). Dad was busy with his startup business when I was young, so you had to manage the household with many responsibilities. I know your career (5) when I was born but I never saw you complain. I wish I had been more aware of the sacrifices you were making when I was younger and that I had been more able to help you out, but I can at least do my best now I am older.

I cannot thank you enough for all you have done for me. I will always cherish you.

Love you forever,

Carrie

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.			

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

C. Parts of Speech (10 marks)

Fill in the blanks with the appropriate forms of the words in brackets.

'The Day I Was Erased' review: Author Lisa Thompson reminds readers that our histories shape us

Eleven-year-old Maxwell Beckett is one of those boys who seldom gets anything right, so he always gets into trouble. Sometimes, it's his own (1) (faultlessly), and sometimes it isn't. Either way, he's sick and tired of trying, failing, and landing in hot water. He often thinks that it would be better for everyone if he had never existed. Be careful what you wish for.

The Day I was Erased, the latest novel from the bestselling author of *The Light Jar* and *Goldfish Boy*, introduces an interesting, off-the-wall (2) (centre) character in an unimaginable situation; a heady mix that will keep even the most reluctant reader turning the pages.

Lisa Thompson's fans know that she is good at intriguing titles and unusual plots. In her third book, she takes a bit of a risk; Maxwell initially comes across as an unsympathetic character. He is a selfish, thoughtless, (3) (disruption) boy who challenges and (4) (intend) riles everyone around him; a trouble-maker both at school and at home. But Thompson cleverly shifts our attitude as we realise his behaviour is a result of his parents' constant (5) (argumentative). How is an 11-year-old supposed to cope with a home life as messy as this?

Maxwell does have a good side that he keeps hidden because it isn't good for his image. He saved his beloved dog, Monster, from a traffic accident, and he regularly visits an elderly neighbour who suffers from dementia. Old Reg has a cupboard full of useless junk. While Maxwell is rummaging through the rubbish in the old man's "cabinet of (6) (curious)", something strange happens. As he walks out of Reg's house, Maxwell discovers that he has been (7) (deletion) from his own life. Nobody recognises him. Everyone he passes – even his parents, neighbours and classmates – treat him as if he were a stranger.

What's more, every (8) (impactful) he has had on where he lives and the people he knows – good or mostly bad – is as if it never happened. Is the world a better place because Maxwell never existed? Can he find a way to get back, or is it already too late?

With nods to that classic Hollywood movie *It's a Wonderful Life* (1946), where the central character is given a chance to see what the world would be like if he had never been born, *The Day I was Erased* is a story of family, the (9) (natural) of friendships, and finding your place in the world. This is an emotional, funny and captivating story with interesting but (10) (flaws) characters and an intriguing central plot. It's another terrific Thompson read to be enjoyed and recommended to all middle-grade fiction readers, or anyone who just enjoys a great story.

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.	6.	7.	8.
9.	10.		

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

D. Open Cloze (5 marks)

Complete the following passage by inserting ONE suitable word in each of the blanks.

The speculation mentality

Speculation has been described as “an activity in which someone buys and sells things in the (1) of making a large profit, but with the risk of a large loss.” But what some call speculation others would see as investment, or doing business. It may not be easy to (2) a clear line.

One thing that is certain (3) speculation is that people see it as a way to make quick money. Experts say the reasons for this include high living costs, high home prices, low interest (4), slow career advancement and limited ways to grow personal assets.

Working hard and saving up is no (5) seen as the route to a better life. Instead, people believe in seizing every opportunity to make a quick buck!

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.			

E. Relative Clauses (10 marks)

Combine the sentences using a relative pronoun. Decide whether a defining or non-defining relative clause is needed. Do not use ‘that’.

1. The man found my passport. He gave it to the police.

2. This dress cost \$200. I bought it in Japan three years ago.

3. My Chinese teacher retired last month. I really admired her.

4. This is the cafe. My mother and I had coffee there on my birthday.

5. The girl is crying. Her hamster has run away.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

F. Multiple-choice Cloze (10 marks)

Read the following text. Decide which of the choices would best complete the text if inserted in the blanks. Write the **letter** of each answer in the space provided.

Born and (1) in Hong Kong, 12-year-old Lance Lau Hin-yi has been a climate activist since 2019. His journey began when he answered a call from well-known Swedish activist Greta Thunberg for young people worldwide to skip school and (2) strike, championing action against climate change.

In March 2019, more than a million students across some 125 countries (3) classes as part of a global initiative called "School Strike for Climate". In Hong Kong, Lance was one of the few local students among the 1,000 protesters taking part in the movement. A majority of the participants were (4) foreigners or international school students.

After the protest, Lance organised a beach clean-up on Lantau Island. Before the campaign, he made leaflets and distributed them to people on the streets. He received permission from his residential estate to put the leaflets on walls in a bid to get people (5). On the day of the clean-up, no one showed up, except him and his parents. "It was a bit sad, but I wasn't too worried," he said, adding that he understood he might not have had enough time to promote the green action.

A few months later, what was believed to be the world's largest-ever global demonstration took place. More than 6 million people from 185 countries took part, demanding that urgent steps be taken to (6) global warming. Lance glued some paper together, made a sign, and waved it through the classroom windows at his school. That action landed him an appointment with the school's social worker.

He was excused (7) class for the entire day and told to instead spend time coming up with ideas on how he could champion his cause without missing out on learning. Lance came up with the idea of standing outside the school for an hour every Friday before classes began, placard in hand to raise awareness on climate change.

"At first some people laughed a bit and rolled their (8)," he recalled. "But after eight weeks, people started to take me really seriously." He has launched other similar actions since, and having moved to Britain, took to the streets last month for his solo demonstration.

Now that he is studying in Britain, he has noticed that Hongkongers and the British see the issue differently. "In England, standing in the street, and just waving a sign, you can get lots of people's attention," he said. "People would honk their horns and be like, 'keep going', giving you lots of (9) comments. The seed has already been planted."

Lance, however, remains hopeful that awareness of climate change is gaining traction in Hong Kong. He stressed that schools must educate teens on the subject. "Understand the (10) of the situation. Decide for yourself what you want to do," he said. "If you're a student, a worker, a teacher or a CEO, do whatever you can."

1. A. rose B. raised C. rised D. risen	2. A. go on B. go against C. go in D. go for	3. A. attended B. formed C. boycotted D. taught
4. A. either B. neither C. both D. not only	5. A. interested B. interest C. interesting D. interests	6. A. deal B. accept C. fight for D. tackle
7. A. in B. from C. by D. of	8. A. heads B. tongues C. hair D. eyes	9. A. supportive B. support C. supporter D. supporting

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

10. A. attitude
B. altitude
C. magnitude
D. latitude

1.	2.	3.	4.	5.
6.	7.	8.	9.	10.

G. Reported Speech (10 marks)

Using a suitable reporting verb form from the boxes in the appropriate form, change the following direct speech into reported speech. You may use each verb ONCE only.

deny	apologise	insist	offer	suggest
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1. 'I am sorry that I forgot your birthday,' Hayden said to Rachel.

2. 'You could arrive early tomorrow,' my teacher said to me.

3. 'Would you let me pay for the damage now?' the stranger asked.

4. 'I did not have a disciplinary meeting,' the student said to his parents.

5. 'We have to share the cost of the meal,' Arthur said to his colleagues.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

H. Proofreading (10 marks)

Proofread the following text (numbered lines 1-10 only) without changing the meaning. No lines have more than one mistake and at least one line is correct. Do not make any changes to punctuation and do not make unnecessary changes. Use ONE word only for each correction. If you think there are no mistakes in a line, put a ✓ at the end of the line (example c).

Corrections must be done as follows:

Extra word: delete the extra word with a 'X' (example a).

Missing word: mark the position of the missing word with a '^' and write the missing word above it (example b).

Wrong word: underline the wrong word and write the correct word above it (example d).

a	When I was younger, my friends and I would X try to scare each other
b	by telling ghost stories. I never got frightened because I did not believe ^ ghosts.
c	In fact, I would laugh at anyone who said they did. However, I changed my ✓
d	mind about this last summer when I was staying <u>at</u> my aunt in Guangzhou.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

- 1 Many people regard Dale Carnegie as the 'father' of public speak and interpersonal skills.
- 2 But most people know him as author of *How to Win Friends and Influence People*, one of the world's
- 3 bestselling self-help books. It was first published in 1936 and around 15 milion copies, some in other
- 4 languages, have been sold worldwide. The book is divided into four major sessions – fundamental techniques
- 5 for handling people; how to make people like you; how to win people around to your way in thinking; and how
- 6 to change them without causing offend or arousing resentment. Each section offers tips for dealing with
- 7 different people and different situations.
- 8 Carnegie, who was bear to a poor farming family in the US state of Missouri in 1888, uses real
- 9 stories and anecdotes to explain untangible things, making a difficult subject easy to digest. It is a book that
- 10 you have to read and reread to get all you can from such an a valuable source of inspiration.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

END OF PAPER

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.